

CURRENT AFFAIRS NOTES: KEY DEVELOPMENTS (UPSC CSE 2026 PREPARATION)

1. SARPA PLATFORM & KERALA FOREST



KEY FEATURES & SERVICES

- CONNECTS CITIZENS WITH CERTIFIED RESCUERS
- MAPS HOSPITALS WITH ANTI-SNAKE VENOM
- HELPS SPECIES IDENTIFICATION

REAL-TIME COORDINATION TOOLS

DIGITAL GOVERNANCE



UPGRADED FOR DOCTORS



- DEDICATED LOGIN ACCESS
- EXPERT GUIDANCE FOR ANTI-SNAKE VENOM (ASV) DOSAGE
- REDUCES CRITICAL TIME-TIME-TO-TREATMENT

2. HANGING GLACIERS IN ALAKNANDA BASIN



DISASTER RISKS

NGT ISSUES



- STUDY IDENTIFIED 219 UNSTABLE HANGING GLACIERS
- STEEP SLOPES, PRECARIOUS NATURE
- RISK OF BREAK-OFFS
- POTENTIAL AVALANCHES THREATEN BADRINATH, MANA, AND NH7, HYDROPOWER PROJECTS

3. RIGHT TO SAFE TRAVELS & ARTICLE 21



FUNDAMENTAL RIGHTS - ARTICLE 21

RIGHT TO SAFE PASSAGE

RIGHT TO SAFE TRAVEL

PART OF RIGHT TO LIFE

- SUPREME COURT RULING ON HIGHWAY SAFETY
- STATE HAS A 'POSITIVE DUTY' TO ENSURE SAFE ROADS
- NO UNLAWFUL OBSTRUCTIONS OR HEAVY VEHICLE PARKING ON SHOULDERS
- POTHOLES TO BE FIXED QUICKLY

4. MAHANADI RIVER DISPUTE



ODISHA - CHHATTISGARH

WATER SHARING DISPUTE

CHHATTISGARH
EIGHT RESERVOIRS
/ BARRAGES

- CLAIMS OBSTRUCTIONS TO NON-MONSOON FLOW
- AFFECTS AGRICULTURE AND ECOLOGY

→ TRIBUNAL ISSUED LAST OPPORTUNITY
FOR MUTUAL SETTLEMENT



UPSC CSE 2026: KEY TOPICS & TRENDS (NOTES)



AI4WaterPolicy: REVOLUTIONIZING COMMUNITY WATER SECURITY



1. PRIMARY GOAL:

AI-helped community-led development for safe and sustainable drinking water.



2. PILOT LOCATION:

352 participants across 350 villages in Rajasthan, India (IWMI & IDS partnership).

3. LIMITATIONS OF CURRENT AI USE:

Information deficit, weak institutional feedback.



4. MODEL & TECHNOLOGY:

AI-assisted qualitative interviews via WhatsApp (voice/text).

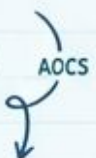


5. IMPACT ON GOVERNANCE:

Moves from static monitoring to adaptive program design.

• KEY FINDINGS:

Closing the loop from messy feedback to structured data.



• EMPOWERMENT:

Increased local confidence.

6. ROLE OF AI:

Human-centric (qualitative data focused).



7. CHALLENGES:

Digital divide (women less likely to use due to access/trust), maintaining feedback loops.

8. CONCLUSION:

Inclusive AI governance model.



RUPEE DEPRECIATION: MACROECONOMIC IMPACT



1. EXTENT OF DEPRECIATION:

Reached record lows against the Dollar (e.g., ₹94/USD in 2026).



2. LEADS TO IMPORTED INFLATION:

Weak currency raises cost of crude oil, electronics, imports.



3. CAPITAL OUTFLOW:

Foreign investors (FPIs) selling Indian equities.



4. IMPACT ON INVESTMENT:

• EQUITY MARKET:

Export-heavy (IT, Pharma) benefit; domestic sectors suffer.



• DEBT MARKET: Rising inflation expectations push up bond yields.



5. BENEFICIARIES OF RUPEE FALL:

• Gold prices rise as hedge.

• Global Investments in foreign funds gain value.



6. INFLATION AFFECTS:

• Interest rates rise to control prices.

• Economic Groups: Lower/middle class face hardship.



7. IMPACT ON INDIVIDUALS:

• Domestic expenses (fuel, food) rise.

• Foreign expenses (education, travel) become much more costly.



MATTALA AIRPORT: 'WHITE ELEPHANT' CASE STUDY



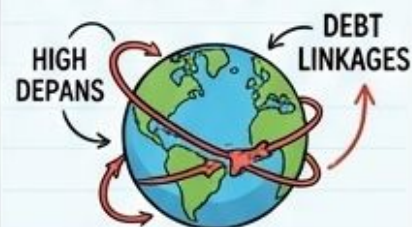
1. BUILT WITH LOANS FROM CHINA:

High-interest debt funded the project.



2. LOCATED NEAR HAMBANTOTA PORT:

Part of a strategic economic zone.



3. CHINA DEBT TRAP POLICY:

Sri Lanka unable to repay, resulting in lease of asset.



• WORLD'S EMPTY AIRPORT: Struggled for scheduled flights, low revenue.

• STRATEGIC & ECOLOGICAL FAILURES:

Wildlife conflict (bird strikes, elephants), loss of strategic asset, failure to generate returns.

